

SESSION 3 · MVP DESIGN

# Frame it. Redesign it. Cut it. Then ask the users.

## From the number you sized in Session 2 to a first version real people can try

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# Today in one picture: from your Session 2 number to a tested brief

## BY THE END OF TODAY YOU CAN

- Explain what your Paylio sheet decided, and why
- Map a process as it is today, and decide where the AI goes
- Cut your feature list until it can fail: RICE and MoSCoW
- Pick the simplest model that does the job, step by step
- Ask six questions before you use any data
- Write a one-page brief, prototype it, show it to five users

## THE STORY OF THE SESSION

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | **Paylio: vote, four pairs, the reference** | 0:03–0:21 |
| | **Governance question · drill #1** | 0:21–0:37 |
| I | **Framing & process redesign · exercise 1** | 0:37–1:00 |
| II | **Prioritising features · exercise 2** | 1:00–1:15 |
| III | **The model-family ladder** | 1:15–1:21 |
| IV | **Data audit & data governance** | 1:21–1:30 |
| V | **Surface, success criterion, brief** | 1:30–1:39 |
| VI | **The design loop: prototype, users** | 1:39–1:49 |
| | **Your team: brief v1, homework** | 1:49–2:00 |

THE PROJECT · FOR EVERY SESSION

# How the course feeds the project you are graded on

| Session | What you commit (the project you are graded on) | Where it is graded |
|---|---|---|
| **S1 Diagnosis** | 01_problem_statement.md · governance.md (6 answers) | problem & do-nothing (oral 2 pts) |
| **S2 Sizing** | 02_sizing.xlsx · 02_investment_memo.md | the business case; the flip assumption |
| **S3 MVP design · today** | **03_product_brief.md v1 → v2 · prototype link · spec.md** | **spec + brief (Git 40 %) · pitch beats 2 & 3** |
| **S4 Build & decode** | /prototype · evals/report_v0.md · 04_architecture.md | “decode the AI architecture” (oral 2 pts) |
| **S5 Metrics** | 05_metrics.md · eval-set v1 | “3 business metrics with expected effects” |
| **S6 Experiments** | 06_ab_protocol.md | “A/B protocol with sample size” (oral 2 pts) |
| **S7 Operation** | 07_operations.md · rollback plan | “adverse effects & monitoring” + rollback |
| **S8 Launch** | 08_launch_memo.md · spec.md · product_brief.md · tag v1.0 | Git 40 % · oral 40 % · individual 10 % · peer 10 % |

**Today builds two beats of your final pitch:** beat 2, the solution (your agent in one sentence, with its trust level), and beat 3, the validation (what users said about your prototype).

FROM SESSION 2 · PAYLIO

# Paylio: every pair votes, four pairs present

### 1 · Every pair · 1 min

Your slide goes in the class folder. Hands up for your decision: GO · NO-GO · CONDITIONAL GO.

### 2 · Four pairs · 3 min each

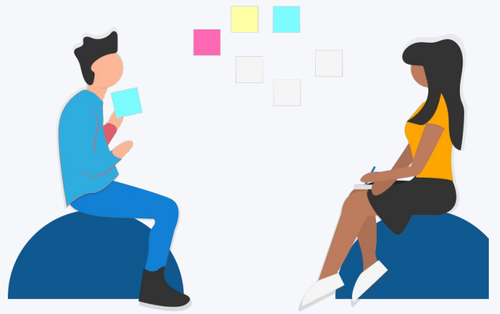
Expected value of the project, of do-nothing, and the hurdle · your decision and its condition · the one number that flips it · the ticket type you left out, and why.

### 3 · The reference · 5 min

The sheet I promised you — and what it says about today.

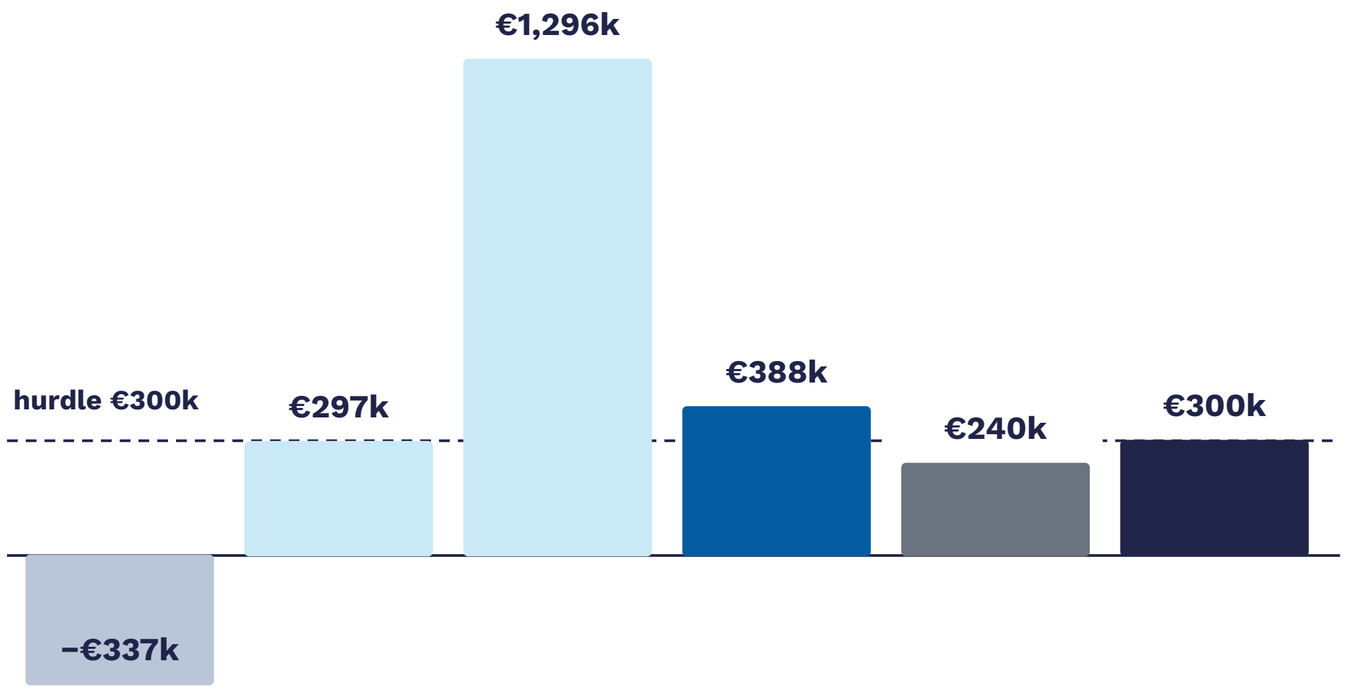
### WHILE THEY PRESENT, LISTEN FOR

- Which numbers were guesses?
- Same facts, different answer: the deflection, the cost of an error, or the probabilities?
- Did they leave out payroll? What did it change?



FROM SESSION 2 · PAYLIO

# The reference sheet: a conditional go, decided by one number




| Pessimistic | Base | Optimistic | Expected value | Do-nothing | Billing portal |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| p = 0.25 | p = 0.50 | p = 0.25 | Σ p × value | agents improve | the hurdle |

*Paylio reference sheet · net value per year, year 1*

**WHAT THE REFERENCE SAYS**

**Base €297k: just under the hurdle.** The expected value clears it only because of the optimistic case → conditional go.

**The flip: deflection ≈ 65 %** of the automatable “how do I” tickets = about 45 % of all of them. That is today's success criterion.

**Leave payroll out: base €370k.** Above the hurdle — a governance choice that is also a business choice.

GOVERNANCE QUESTION OF THE DAY · 3 MIN

# Amazon's recruiting model, 2018: which check would have caught it?

## WHAT HAPPENED

- Amazon trained an experimental model on ten years of CVs sent to the company, to score new candidates.
- Most past hires were men. The model learned it: it penalised CVs with the word “women's” and downgraded graduates of two all-women's colleges.
- Engineers removed those words, but nobody could promise the model had not found other clues. Recruiters looked at its rankings but never relied on them alone; Amazon disbanded the team by early 2017.

*Source: Reuters, Jeffrey Dastin, 10 October 2018*

## THE QUESTION

**Which step of the product loop would have caught it — and with which check?**

Keep your answer. We come back to it in Part IV, the data audit.



EXAM PRACTICE · ALONE · NO AI

# Flawed-brief drill #1: find three flaws in seven minutes

**AI SUPPORT ASSISTANT — PRODUCT BRIEF (DRAFT, AI-GENERATED)**

**Problem.** Customers wait too long for answers; our agents are overloaded.

**Solution.** An autonomous AI agent handles all incoming tickets end-to-end and escalates only when it decides it cannot help. It uses the latest LLM, with retrieval over our whole knowledge base and ticket history.

**Users.** All customers and all agents. **Data.** All historical tickets (3 years) and the knowledge base.

**Model.** GPT-class model via API, fine-tuned on our tickets.

**Success.** Better support experience, much lower costs, accuracy above 90 %.

**Timeline.** MVP in 3 weeks, full rollout in 6. **Risks.** It may hallucinate sometimes; we will monitor.

**HOW TO READ IT**

- Read it as a CFO, a DPO and an engineer
- Name the flaw, then the idea it breaks
- Three flaws are enough; a fourth is a bonus

**07:00**

7 min writing · 3 min answers

EXAM PRACTICE · AFTER THE SEVEN MINUTES

# Drill #1, the answers: three flaws, three ideas, two bonuses

## 01

### Nothing is cut

“All tickets, all customers, all agents, end-to-end.” No process was mapped and nothing is out of scope. That is the whole product, not a first version.

**PARTS I–II · FRAMING & CUTTING**

## 02

### No success criterion

“Better experience”, “accuracy above 90 %”. Accuracy of what, on which tickets, by when, with which guardrail?

**PART V · SUCCESS CRITERION**

## 03

### Wrong rung, wrong trust level

A fine-tuned autonomous agent where a classifier, a draft and a few rules would do. “Escalates only when it decides” means L4 everywhere, on day one.

**PART III · THE LADDER**

**Bonus flaws.** “Fine-tuned on our tickets” with no data audit and no legal basis (Part IV). “We will monitor” with no rollback trigger (Session 7). The DPO and the on-call engineer read those two first.

WHY THIS SESSION

# Scope is the only lever you fully control

### Under-specifying

A brief nobody can build: no process mapped, no criterion, no data. The cure: framing questions and a one-page brief.

### Over-engineering

An agent where a rule would do, a feature list instead of a first version. The cure: the ladder and prioritisation.

### Designing at a desk

A brief approved only by the team that wrote it. The cure: a prototype and five users before you build.

## WHAT THE SURVEYS SAY

**≈ 3×**

McKinsey, State of AI (Aug 2026, n = 1,719): nearly three in four AI high performers have redesigned their workflows, against one in four of the others.

**10-20-70**

BCG's rule of thumb: 10 % of the effort on algorithms, 20 % on technology and data, 70 % on people and processes.

**37 %**

Deloitte, State of AI in the Enterprise (Jan 2026, n = 3,235): use AI “at a surface level”, with little or no change to how the work is done.

THE BRIDGE FROM SESSION 2

# From the flip point in your memo to the success criterion of your MVP

**S2 — THE SHEET SAID**

**Conditional go: the project beats the billing portal only if deflection on "how do I…" tickets reaches about 65 %.**

65 % of the automatable ones = 0.68 × 0.65 ≈ **45 % of all "how do I…" tickets**. One number. Everything else in the sheet can wait.

**S3 — SO THE MVP IS**

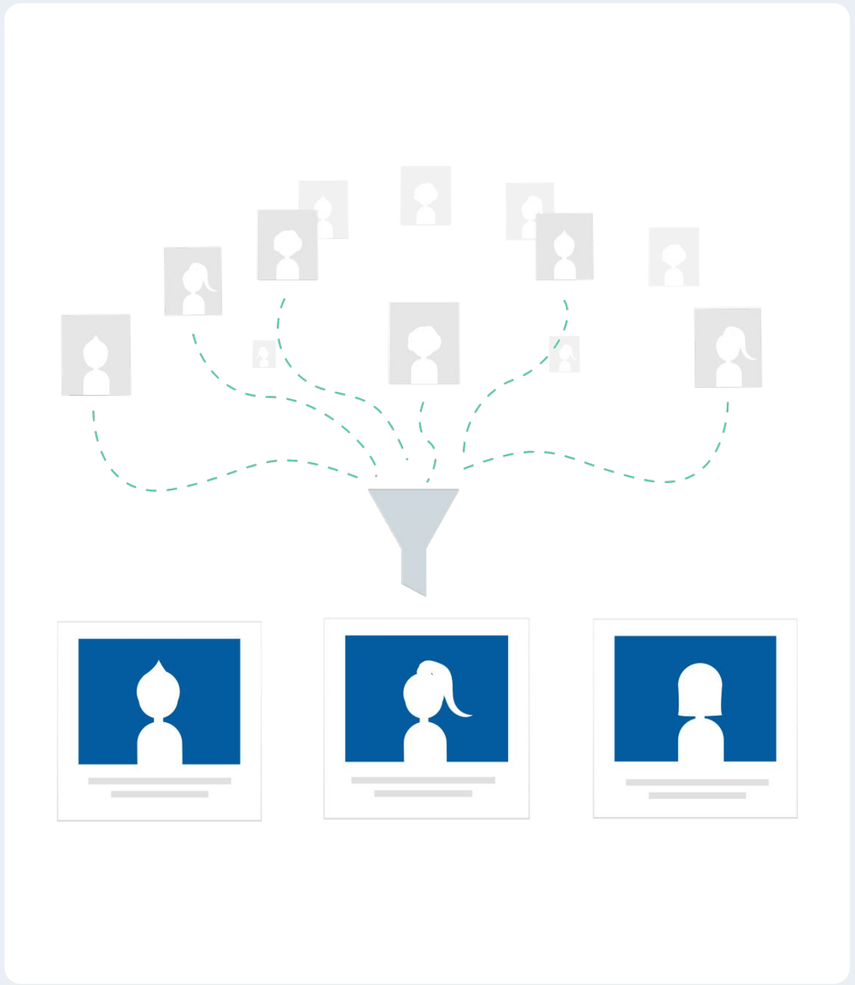
**The smallest thing that can pass or fail that 45 % test, on real tickets, with real users.**

Same move as the press release in Session 1, one level down: design backwards from the test that settles the question.

**The rule for today: everything you keep helps you pass or fail that test faster. Everything else goes on the out-of-scope list.**

# Framing the work, redesigning the process

Ten questions before anything else; the process as it is, measured; automate, augment or keep human; the to-be with a trust level per step.



# The ten framing questions a kick-off must answer

**01**
### Decision & owner
Which decision, who makes it, by when?
S1

**02**
### Users & jobs
Who does the work today? What job?
S1

**03**
### Process as-is
Steps, volumes, minutes, errors, cost. Measured.
today

**04**
### Where the pain sits
Which two steps take the time or the errors?
today

**05**
### Constraints
Systems, legal, budget, deadline
today

**06**
### Data reality
What exists, who owns it, may we use it?
today

**07**
### What “done” means
One criterion, with its guardrail
S1 · today

**08**
### What must never happen
Your first guardrail
S1

**09**
### Do-nothing & hurdle
What improves anyway? What competes?
S2

**10**
### Riskiest assumption
The one number the MVP measures first
S2

**Question 3 in adjectives? The kick-off is not finished. Question 10 empty? You are building a product, not an MVP.**

FRAMING · PROCESS REDESIGN

# Redesigning a process with AI: five steps, always in this order

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Map the as-is** | Who does each step, how many, how long, how often wrong, what it costs. Watch two people do it; don't ask them to describe it. |
| 02 | **Find the pain** | Two steps usually carry most of the minutes or the errors. The AI goes there — not where it is easiest. |
| 03 | **Sort each task** | Automate, augment or keep human: the eight tests on the next slide, plus the cost of an error at that step. |
| 04 | **Design the to-be** | AI at the pain steps, a trust level per step, a person where the money or the emotion is. Draw the way out first. |
| 05 | **Count the change** | Minutes, cost and quality per step, before and after. These are the numbers your sizing sheet needed. |

*Order matters. Start at step 4 (“where can we put an AI?”) and you get Klarna: no way back to a person. Start at step 1 and you get Octopus.*

# Automate, augment or keep human: eight tests

**01**

**Clear input, clear output**

Support: a ticket in, a category out

**02**

**Lots of examples exist**

Support: years of tickets and answers

**03**

**Clear feedback**

Support: resolved, reopened, satisfaction

**04**

**No long chain of reasoning**

Support: one ticket, one answer

**05**

**No need to explain in detail**

Support: citations are enough

**06**

**Errors are cheap**

Support: a wrong answer can be fixed

**07**

**The world changes slowly**

Support: docs stable for months

**08**

**No hands needed**

Support: screen work only

**Passes them all → automate.** Fails 5 or 6 (explain, errors) → augment: the AI drafts, a person decides. Fails several → keep it human. **The cost of an error sets the trust level.** Adapted from Brynjolfsson & Mitchell, Science, 2017.

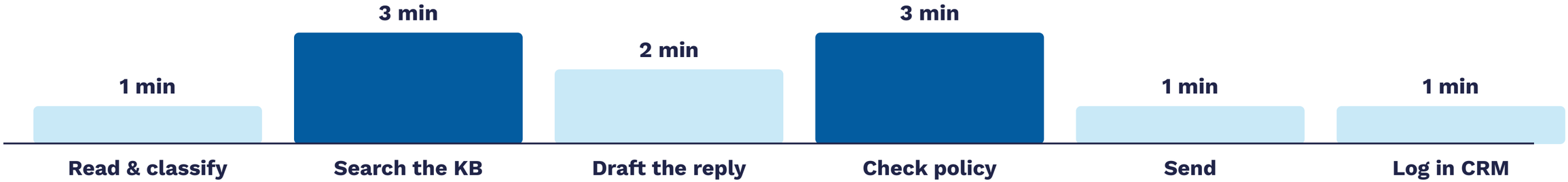
FRAMING · WORKED EXAMPLE

# Karim's ticket, before and after: 11 minutes → about 2 minutes of his time

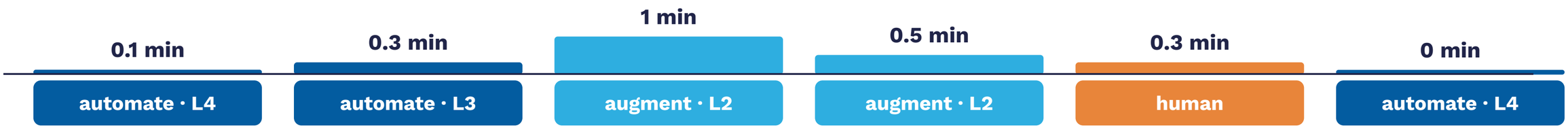


**Karim, from Session 1.** One “how do I…” ticket. Search and policy are the two tall bars on his journey map: 6 of his 11 minutes, about 40 % of his day.

## BEFORE — 11 MIN OF KARIM'S TIME




## AFTER — 2.2 MIN OF KARIM'S TIME




*Illustrative minutes. “Send” stays with Karim: that is the way back to a person, designed first. Each step now reports one metric: routing accuracy, search hit rate, draft acceptance, policy catches, satisfaction.*

# Three companies, three redesigns, three outcomes

| | Klarna · fintech · 2024 | Octopus Energy · 2023 | Morgan Stanley · 2023 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Where the AI went** | In the customer chat, end-to-end | Behind the e-mail reply; a person reads each one | Inside the advisor's tools: search over the research library |
| **Trust level, day one** | L4 with escalation | L2 — supervised drafts | L2 — the advisor decides |
| **Way back to a person** | Added late: “always a human if you want” (May 2025) | Built in: the person was the process | Not needed: the advisor is the user |
| **Published result** | 2.3 M chats, work of 700 agents; then quality dropped, humans re-hired | From 34 % to 45 % of e-mails; satisfaction 80 % vs 65 % for humans | 98 % of advisor teams use it; access to documents 20 % → 80 % |
| **Lesson for step 4** | Draw the way back before you automate | Start supervised; let the numbers raise the level | Put it inside the existing workflow |

*Sources: Klarna press release (27 Feb 2024), Bloomberg (8 May 2025) · Octopus Energy, Greg Jackson (2023) · Morgan Stanley / OpenAI customer story. Order-of-magnitude check: McKinsey Global Institute (June 2023) — generative AI could cut human-handled contacts by up to 50 %.*

FRAMING · PRACTICE

# Exercise 1: redesign a refund process — 10 min, pairs

**TODAY: A REFUND REQUEST AT A LOGISTICS SAAS (P4'S WORLD) · ILLUSTRATIVE**

| Step | Who | Min | Errors | Cost of an error |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1. Read the request, find the order** | agent | 2 | 2 % | wrong order refunded |
| **2. Check the refund policy** | agent | 4 | 8 % | refund outside policy |
| **3. Check tracking / proof of delivery** | agent | 3 | 5 % | refund on a delivered parcel |
| **4. Decide the amount** | agent; lead if > €100 | 2 | 3 % | over-refund |
| **5. Write to the customer** | agent | 3 | 1 % | wrong tone or wording |
| **6. Pay the refund, log it** | agent | 2 | 1 % | double refund |

**16 min per request · 6,000 requests a month · 30 % under €20**

**FOR EACH STEP, WRITE**

- automate, augment or keep human — and which test it fails
- a trust level (L1–L4)
- the way back to a person
- minutes of human time after
- one metric per step
- where the governance line sits

**DEBRIEF · 3 MIN**

Where did you keep a person, and why? Did anyone split step 4 by amount?

II

# Prioritising the features

Once the process says where the AI goes, you still have too many features. RICE, MoSCoW, Kano and WSJF help you cut.



# RICE on eight features of the support agent

| Feature | Reach / month | Impact | Confid. | Effort (wks) | RICE | Decision |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Policy checker (no price, no refund)** | 22,000 | 2 | 100 % | 0.5 | 88,000 | MUST |
| **Routing with a confidence score** | 40,000 | 1 | 100 % | 1 | 40,000 | SHOULD |
| **Feedback thumbs for agents** | 22,000 | 1 | 80 % | 0.5 | 35,200 | SHOULD |
| **Draft with KB citations** | 22,000 | 3 | 50 % | 3 | 11,000 | MUST |
| **Customer chat widget** | 40,000 | 2 | 50 % | 6 | 6,667 | WON'T |
| **Sentiment flag** | 40,000 | 0.5 | 50 % | 1.6 | 6,250 | COULD |
| **Auto-close resolved tickets** | 22,000 | 0.5 | 80 % | 2.2 | 4,000 | COULD |
| **Multilingual answers** | 8,000 | 2 | 50 % | 4 | 2,000 | WON'T |

**RICE ranks.**
**You decide.**

*RICE = R × I × C ÷ E · Sean McBride, Intercom*

**The draft is only 4th, yet it is a MUST:** its confidence is low because it is your riskiest assumption — so you build it first, to learn. The widget scores the same and is cut: it talks to customers, a higher trust level than this MVP.

# MoSCoW: the board that becomes your out-of-scope list

## MUST

the MVP fails without it

- Draft with KB citations
- Policy checker
- One-click escalate, with context
- Eval-set of 200 tickets

## SHOULD

important, not vital

- Routing + confidence
- Feedback thumbs
- Citation preview

## COULD

if time allows

- Sentiment flag
- Auto-close
- Tone selector

## WON'T

this time — written down

- Customer chat widget
- Multilingual answers
- Payroll tickets
- Billing tickets
- Any reply sent without a person

### RULE OF THUMB

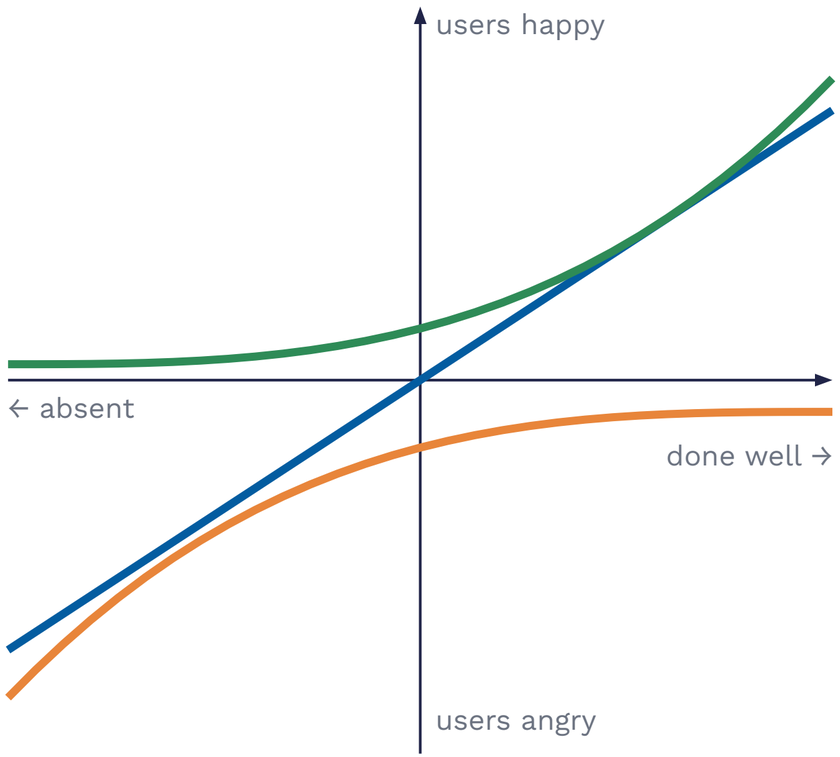
**MUST ≤ 4, or it is not an MVP. WON'T ≥ 5, or nothing was cut.**

### ICE, THE FAST ONE

Impact × Confidence × Ease, 1 to 10 each (Sean Ellis). Use it before you have volumes.

**The WON'T column is the most useful one: you write it down, date it, and defend it at the oral.** MoSCoW: Dai Clegg, Oracle, 1994.

# Kano and WSJF: what users expect, and what waiting costs




**Delighter**

the draft is ready before the ticket opens

**Performance**

a faster first answer, more tickets resolved

**Must-be**

one-click escalate; never a wrong refund

*Noriaki Kano, 1984. Must-be features go in MUST — nobody thanks you for them, everybody notices when they are missing.*

**WSJF — WEIGHTED SHORTEST JOB FIRST**

Cost of delay ÷ size. Cost of delay = user value + time criticality + risk reduction (Reinertsen; SAFe).

| Feature | Cost of delay | Size | WSJF |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Policy checker** | 8 | 1 | 8.0 |
| **Eval-set of 200** | 10 | 2 | 5.0 |
| **Draft with citations** | 13 | 5 | 2.6 |
| **Customer widget** | 5 | 8 | 0.6 |

The eval-set has no user value, but it removes risk and it is small: it jumps up the list. That is why it is a MUST.

# Exercise 2: score your own agent's features — 8 min, teams

### 1 · List

Eight candidate features of your agent: at least one per step of your to-be process, plus the two a flawed brief would promise.

### 2 · RICE

Reach from your 02_sizing.xlsx (tickets a month), impact 0.25–3, confidence 50 / 80 / 100 %, effort in person-weeks. Be honest about confidence.

### 3 · MoSCoW

At most 4 MUST, at least 5 WON'T. The WON'T column goes straight into 03_product_brief.md as your out-of-scope list.

**PUT IT IN YOUR BRIEF**

- the RICE table, sorted
- the MoSCoW board
- one sentence: which feature tests your flip assumption — and why it is a MUST even if its RICE is not the highest
- one sentence: the cut that hurt the most

Two teams show their board. Six MUSTs, or an empty WON'T column, means the process step is not done.

# The model-family ladder

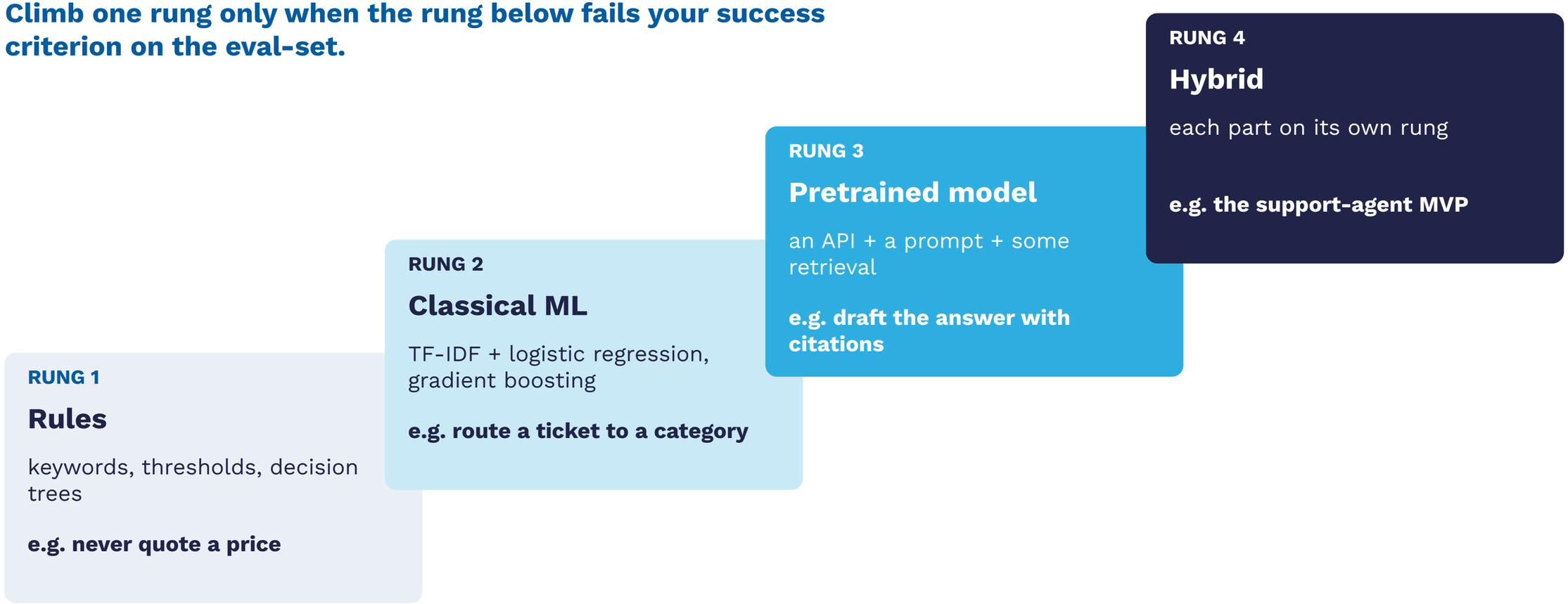
Rules → classical ML → pretrained model → hybrid. Climb one rung only when the one below fails.



THE MODEL-FAMILY LADDER

# Four rungs, and one rule for climbing

**Climb one rung only when the rung below fails your success criterion on the eval-set.**




*Google, Rules of ML #1: “Don't be afraid to launch a product without machine learning.” Gartner (June 2025): many use cases sold as agentic don't need agents; only about 130 of thousands of “agentic” vendors are real.*

THE LADDER · APPLIED

# Your agent on the ladder: one rung per part

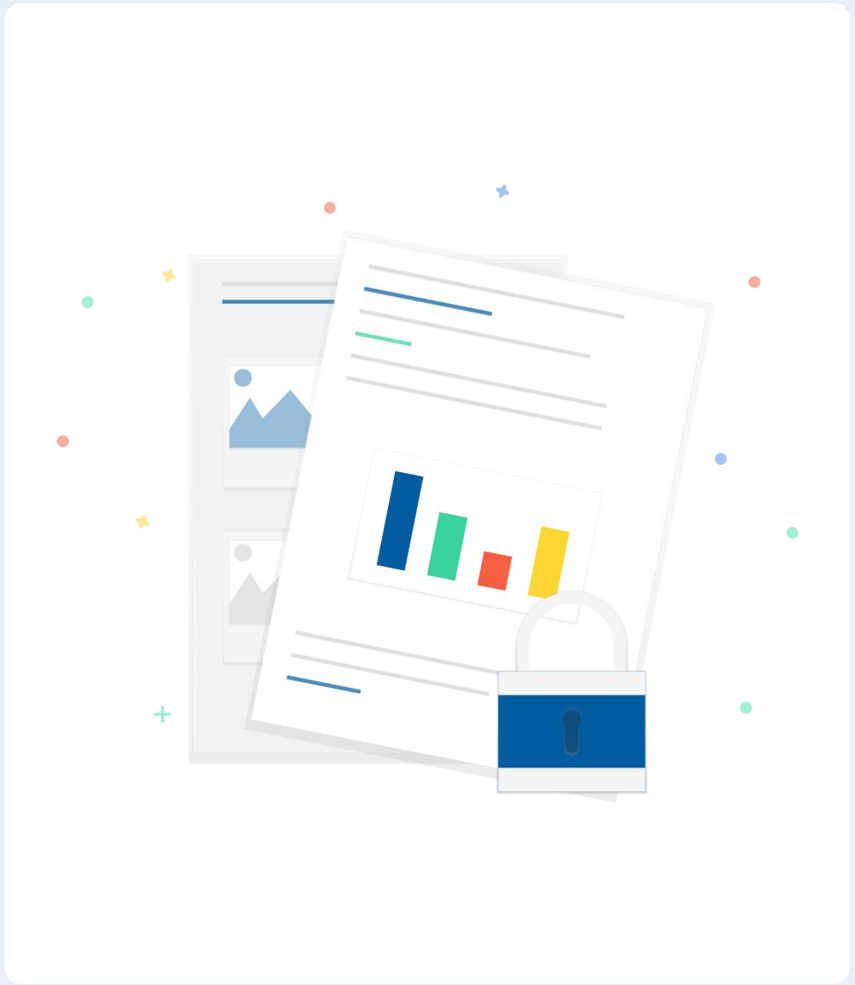
| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Route a ticket to a category** | **Rung 2 · classical ML** | cheap, explainable, gives a confidence score for free |
| **Draft the answer with citations** | **Rung 3 · pretrained model + retrieval** | writing needs a language model; retrieval keeps it on the facts |
| **Never quote a price, never promise a refund** | **Rung 1 · a rule** | a keyword list and a block — the model is not trusted with this |
| **The MVP** | **Rung 4 · hybrid** | not because it sounds advanced: each part sits on its own rung |

*You build exactly this hybrid in Session 4, on 30 October, in Streamlit — starting from your brief v2.*

# IV

# The dataset audit — and data governance

Six questions before you use any data — and the answer to this morning's Amazon question.



THE DATASET AUDIT

# Six questions to ask any dataset before it touches the product

## 01

### Provenance

Where does each row come from? Who collected it, when, how?

## 02

### Volume & labels

How many rows? Labelled by whom, with which guideline?

## 03

### Coverage

Which languages, plans, regions are there — versus the users you ship to?

## 04

### Rights

Which legal basis? Does the customer contract allow this use? How long do we keep it?

## 05

### Leakage

Can a training row show up in the test — or in another customer's answer?

## 06

### Freshness

How old is it? Does the world it describes still exist?

**The DPO asks 4 first. 3 and 6 are the ones that break in production. Output: a one-page datasheet. You run it on reviews.csv at the start of S4.**

# Data governance, inside the audit

### Legal basis

GDPR art. 6: contract, legitimate interest or consent. In B2B, the customer contract decides whether tickets may train anything.

### Purpose & retention

GDPR art. 5: data collected to answer a ticket is not automatically data to train a model. Say why, say how long.

### Isolation between customers

Can customer A's ticket appear in customer B's answer? It happens in the retrieval index: a design requirement.

### Who is in the data

Labels copy the people who made them — the Amazon answer. Check results by language, plan and region before you train.

### Two documents

Datasheets for Datasets (Gebru et al., 2021) and Model Cards (Mitchell et al., 2019): what an auditor asks for.

### EU AI Act

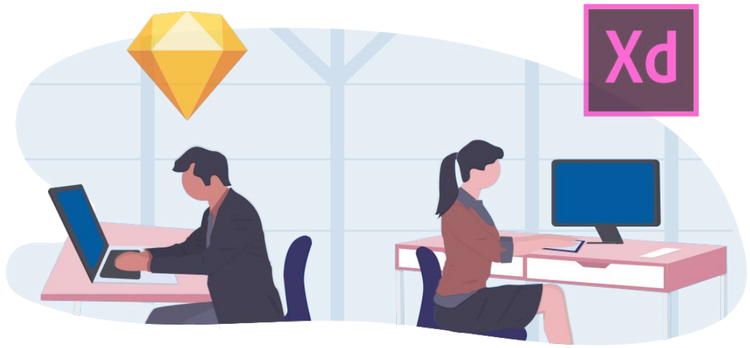
Art. 10 makes data governance a duty for high-risk systems. A support agent usually is not high-risk; the habit is the same.

**In governance.md today:** sources, legal basis, purpose, retention, isolation, known gaps by segment — and the trust level per step.

# V

# Surface, criterion, brief

Where the product lives, the one sentence that says pass or fail, the trust level per step, and the one-page brief.



# The success criterion: one sentence, five parts you already have

**“By 30 October, on our 200-ticket eval-set, at least 45 % of ‘how do I…’ tickets get a draft that two graders would send without editing — and no draft quotes a price or promises a refund.”**

### METRIC

**share of tickets whose draft is sendable as is**

Two graders read each draft: “would you send this unchanged?” Yes = one ticket solved without a person = deflection, the S2 variable — measured before launch.

### THRESHOLD

**≥ 45 % of “how do I” tickets**

Session 2 — your flip point. For Paylio: 65 % of automatable tickets ≈ 45 % of all of them.

### GUARDRAIL

**no price, no refund promised**

Part III — the rung-1 rule. The model is not trusted with money.

### DATA

**the eval-set**

Part IV — audited, frozen, never tuned on. 20 tickets today, 200 by Session 5.

### DATE

**a session, not “soon”**

30 October in the example. Yours: 6 November — the prototype is measured against this sentence.

**One criterion.** Two is a roadmap, not a test. This afternoon the prototype is judged by this sentence; in Session 5 it grows into a metric hierarchy.

# The one-page brief — where it all lands — and its twin for the machine

### 03_product_brief.md — for people

- Problem · user · do-nothing (from 01)
- To-be process, trust level per step
- In scope (MUST ≤ 4) · out of scope (WON'T ≥ 5)
- Data — from the audit
- Model — one rung per part
- Where it lives
- Success criterion — one sentence
- Risks · rollback trigger



### spec.md — for Claude Code, in S4

- problem: one paragraph
- workflow: steps with inputs and outputs
- contracts: ticket → category, confidence, draft, citations
- edge cases: no KB hit · not English · personal data
- fallbacks: confidence < 0.7 → escalate
- done: ≥ 45 % sendable on the eval-set
- out of scope: payroll · billing · widget
- eval-set: evals/tickets_v0.csv

**Prose lets you skip the contracts and the fallbacks. The spec does not. Write both. Next slide: everything on one page, the AI Lean Canvas.**

# The AI Lean Canvas: Sessions 1, 2 and 3 on one page

**PROBLEM** S1

Karim spends 40 % of his day in the KB and the policy; 14 h first answer at night

**SOLUTION** S3

Draft with citations · policy checker · one-click escalate

**KEY METRIC** S3

≥ 45 % of drafts sendable without edit

**VALUE PROPOSITION** S1

A checked draft with its sources, ready before Karim opens the ticket

**UNFAIR ADVANTAGE** S2

Our own tickets and KB — a vendor does not have them

**CHANNEL** S3

Inside the agent inbox Karim already uses

**USERS** S1

Tier-1 agents like Karim · Paylio's 2,500 customer companies

**COSTS** S2

Seven cost lines: tokens, integration, evals, supervision, monitoring…

**VALUE (NOT REVENUE: AN INTERNAL PRODUCT)** S2

Base €297k a year · EV €388k vs the €300k hurdle

## THE FIVE AI BLOCKS — WHAT A CLASSIC LEAN CANVAS FORGETS

**DATA** S3

Tickets + KB · contract OK? · gaps by language

**MODEL** S3

Rules + classifier + LLM with retrieval

**EVALUATION** S3

200-ticket eval-set, two graders

**HUMAN IN THE LOOP** S3

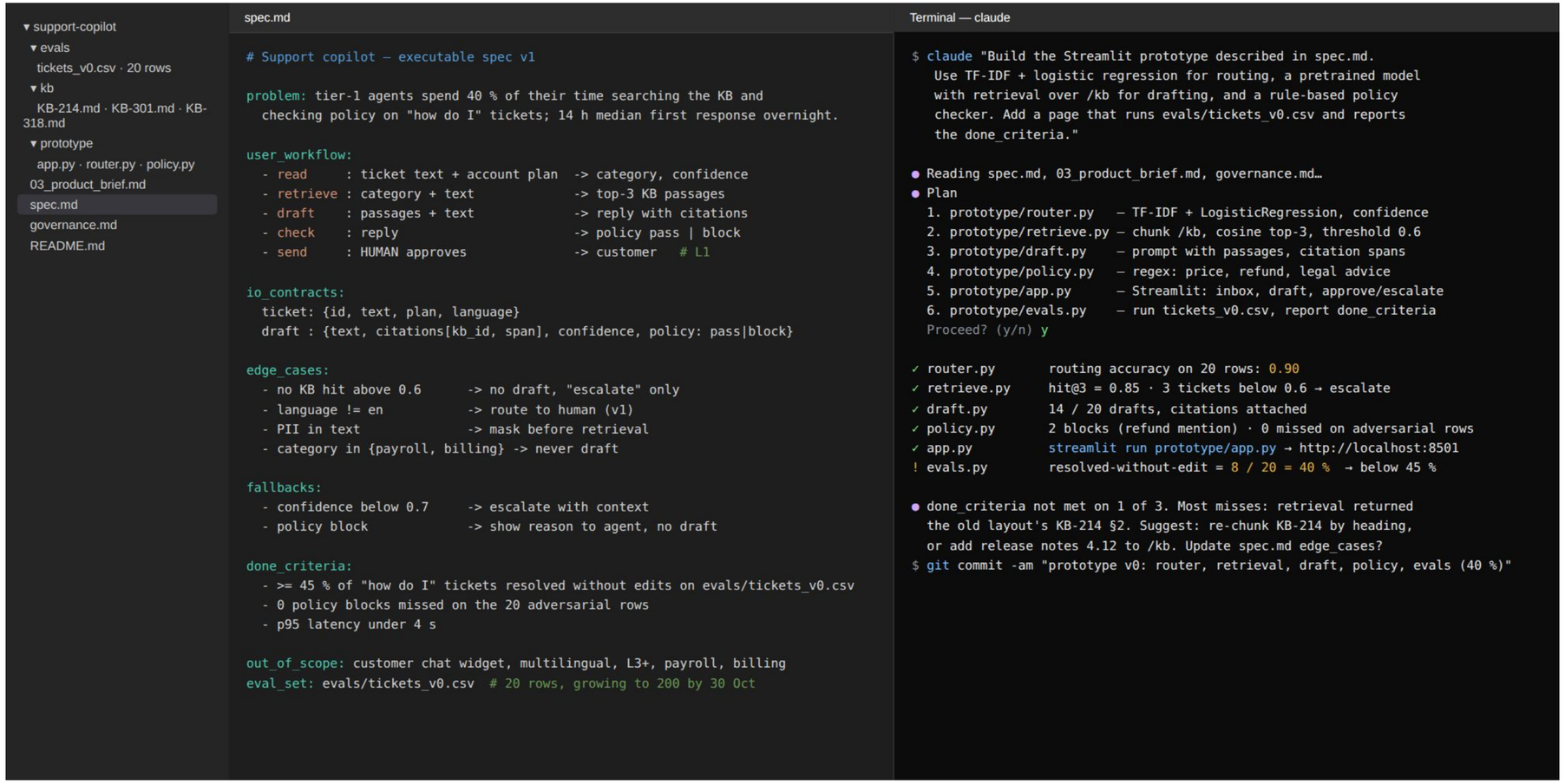
L2 on drafts · “send” stays human

**RISKS** S3

Never quote a price · rollback trigger

*Lean Canvas: Ash Maurya, Running Lean (2010), adapted from the Business Model Canvas. Paylio example — your team fills 03_ai_lean_canvas.md.*

# S4 preview — spec-to-dev: spec.md + Claude Code




*Illustrative mockup. The spec you write now is what the agent reads in S4. At the bottom: 40 % sendable against the 45 % target — that conversation between spec and prototype is Session 4.*

# VI

## The design loop

Pick a tool, prompt from your brief, show it to five users — and decide before you build.

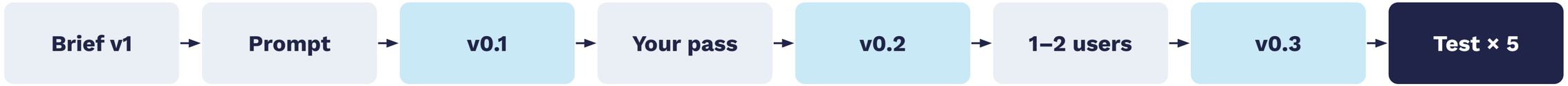


# The 2026 prototyping toolbox: pick by what the test needs

| Tool | You give it | You get | Best for |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Claude Design (Anthropic Labs, April 2026, preview)** | a prompt, your brand, a screenshot | clickable prototypes, comments, a hand-off bundle for Claude Code | testing a flow with users |
| **Figma Make** | a Figma frame + a prompt | a clickable prototype from the mockup | teams already in Figma |
| **Lovable** | a prompt, then a conversation | a web app with a back-end and a public link | a prototype that holds data |
| **v0 · Bolt** | a prompt | React code / a full app in the browser | people who want to read the code |
| **Claude artifact · Claude Code** | a message / your spec.md | a clickable page / a real prototype on real tickets | a quick demo / the S4 build |

**In every tool, the first prompt is your brief in three paragraphs.** That is why the brief comes first. Tools change every month: check them the week you use them.

# The desirability gate: prompt, versions, five users, then decide



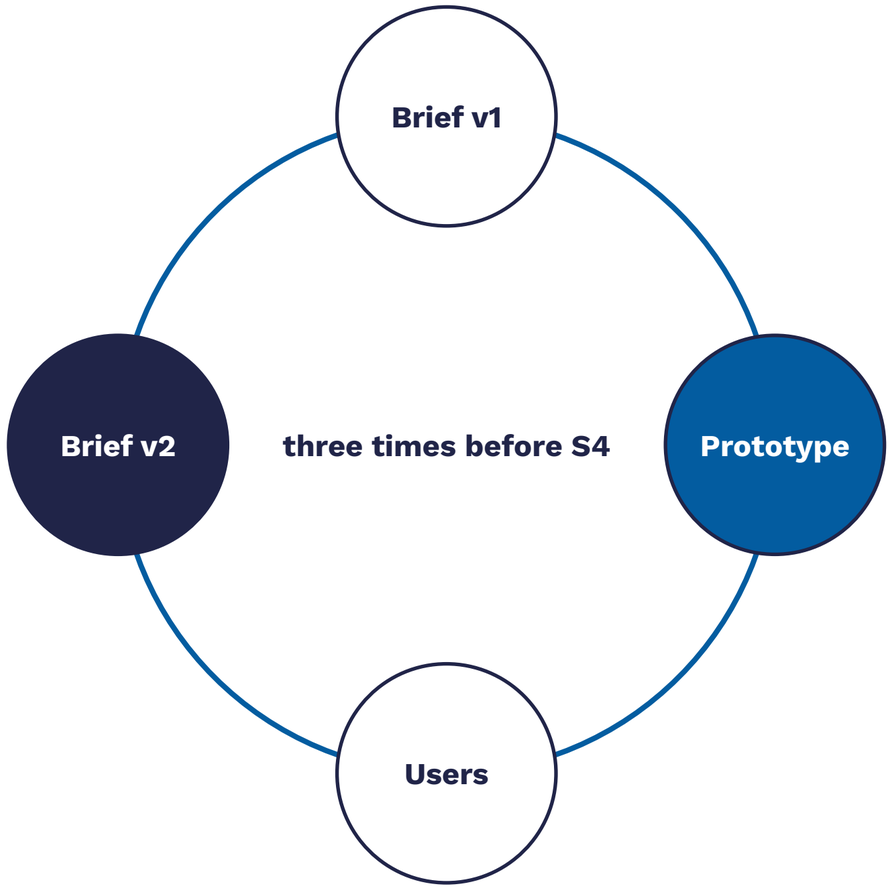

*one afternoon · the prompt is your brief in three paragraphs · each test: one task, 20 minutes*




**"Yes" means:** 4 of 5 finish the task without help · they tell you what they did last time, not what they would do · one says "I want this before…" · your out-of-scope list grew, your criterion did not move.

| Desirability | Feasibility | Viability | Ethics & governance |
|---|---|---|---|
| do they want it? | can we build it? | is it worth it? | should we? |
| **prototype + 5 users · today** | **S4 prototype + eval-set** | **S2 memo, the hurdle** | **governance.md** |

# From brief to clickable inbox: an afternoon, not a quarter




## THE BUILD

- Three paragraphs from the brief → Claude Design, Lovable, v0 or a Claude artifact
- A ticket list, a draft with citations, an “escalate” button: Karim's inbox, nothing more
- Live if we have time; otherwise the next two slides show the result

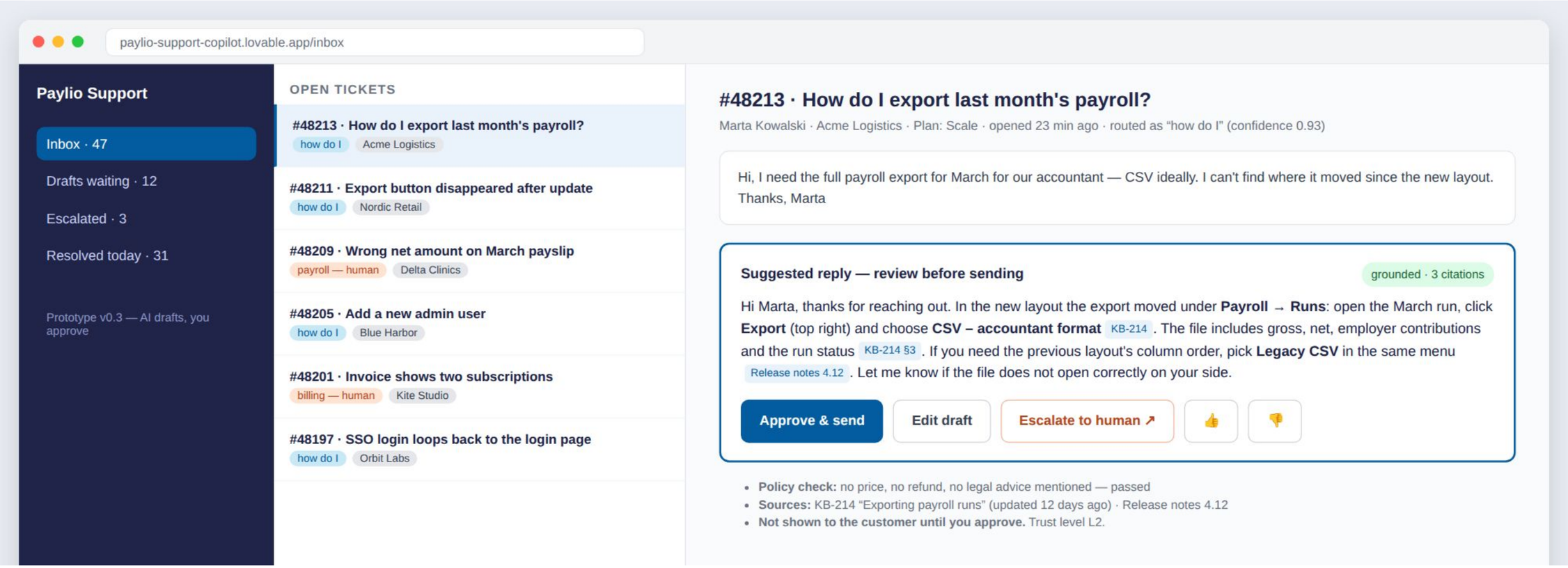
## WHAT IT IS — AND IS NOT

**For:** putting something in front of a user today

**Not:** the S4 prototype, which runs on real tickets

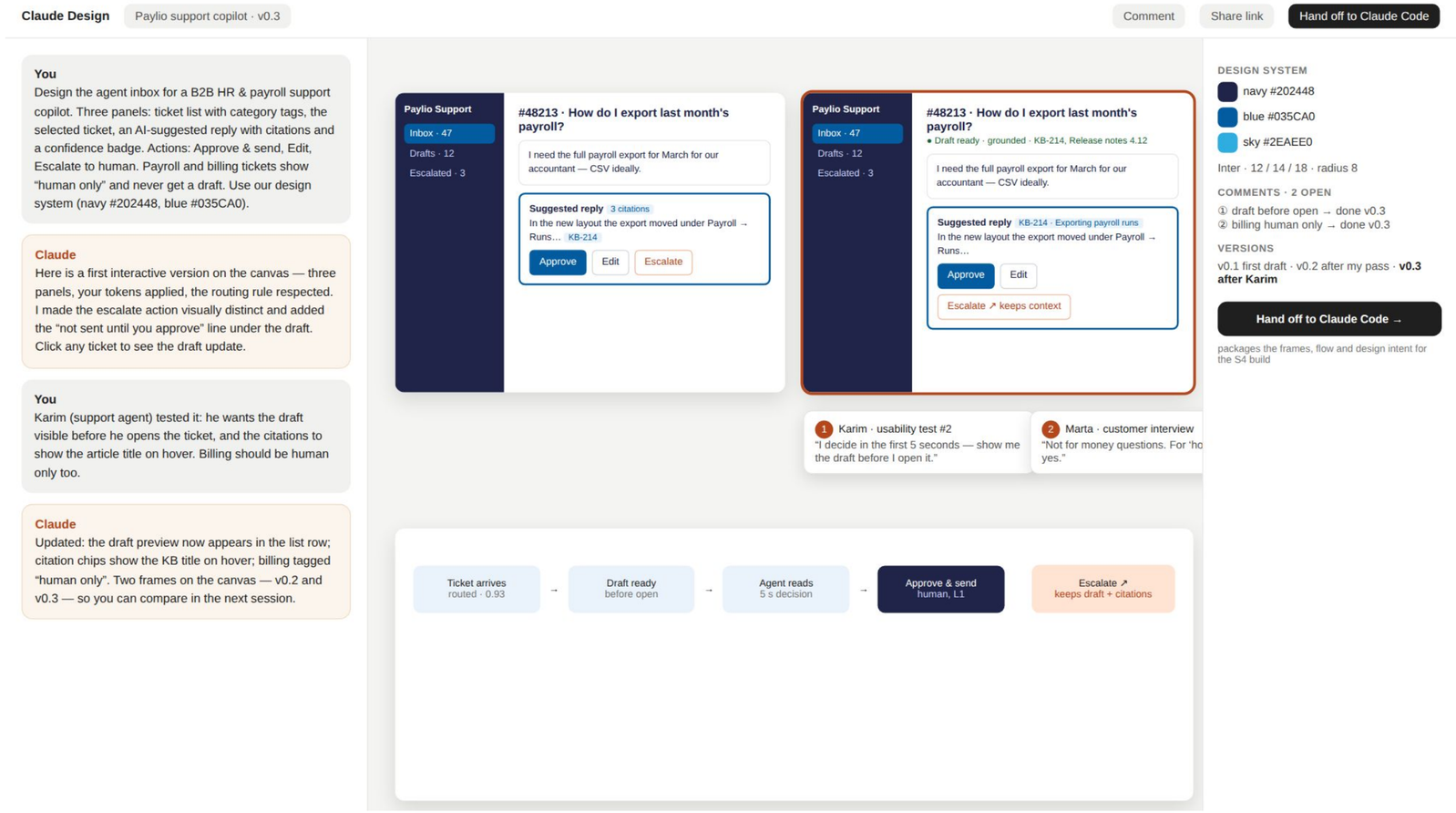
**Not:** production code

# What the prototype looks like: Karim's inbox in ten minutes




*Illustrative mockup, not a real screenshot. What a user can already react to: the routing tag, "human only" tickets, the draft with citations, the three buttons, the policy line.*

# In Claude Design: two versions, a user's comment, a hand-off




*Illustrative mockup, not a real screenshot. Left: the prompt and a user's reaction. Centre: v0.2 and v0.3 side by side. Right: comments, versions, and the hand-off to Claude Code.*

# User research that fits in a week



**Five users find most usability problems on a simple task** (Nielsen & Landauer, 1993 — with caveats: simple tasks, similar users).

### The test, in five lines

One task. Think aloud. Don't help. Note where they hesitate. Ask what they expected. (Steve Krug, 2009)

### The Mom Test

Never “would you use this?” — everybody says yes to be nice. Ask what they did the last time the export failed at 11 pm. (Rob Fitzpatrick, 2013)

### Wizard of Oz

A person secretly plays the “AI” for a day. The cheapest way to learn what the agent must say.

### A habit, not a phase

Talk to one user every week (Teresa Torres, Continuous Discovery Habits, 2021).

### Tools

Maze or UserTesting on your prototype link; Dovetail or Granola to record. AI summaries are fast — read the transcripts anyway.

### Who to ask

One person who has done tier-1 support, two people who use a B2B tool. Classmates in role if needed — say so.

# What users change — and what they cannot decide

### USERS CHANGE

- The moment: Karim wants the draft before he opens the ticket
- The place: inside his inbox, not in a new tab
- The out-of-scope list: “no bot for billing questions”
- The words: escalation, citations, what “confidence” looks like

### USERS CANNOT DECIDE

- The threshold of your criterion — that is your S2 flip point
- The model — that is the eval-set
- The legal basis — that is the audit
- Whether they would “like an AI assistant” — everybody says yes

**Research shapes the design; the experiment decides if it ships.** That second part is Session 6.

# Brief v1 → v2: the diff the users produced

### 03_product_brief.md

V1 — BEFORE THE USERS · 16 OCT

**SOLUTION — IN SCOPE**

- AI draft with citations for "how do I" tickets, in a separate **AI tab**
- Agent reviews the draft **after opening the ticket**
- One-click escalate
- Policy checker (no price, no refund)

**OUT OF SCOPE**

- Customer chat widget
- Multilingual
- Payroll tickets
- L3+ autonomy

**INTEGRATION SURFACE**

- A new "AI assistant" tab in the agent console

**SUCCESS CRITERION**

- ≥ 45 % of "how do I" tickets resolved without an agent, at unchanged CSAT, on the 200-ticket eval-set, by 30 Oct

### 03_product_brief.md

V2 — WHAT THE USERS CHANGED · 22 OCT

**SOLUTION — IN SCOPE**

- AI draft with citations for "how do I" tickets, ~~in a separate AI tab~~ inside the inbox, under the customer message — *3 / 3 users never opened the tab*
- Agent reviews the draft ~~after opening the ticket~~ draft is ready before the ticket is opened; "why this draft" shows the citations — *Karim: "I decide in the first 5 seconds"*
- One-click escalate that keeps the draft and the citations as context — *2 / 3 lost context when escalating*
- Policy checker (no price, no refund)

**OUT OF SCOPE**

- Customer chat widget
- Multilingual
- Payroll tickets
- Billing tickets — *both customers: "not for money questions"*
- L3+ autonomy

**INTEGRATION SURFACE**

- ~~A new "AI assistant" tab~~ The existing agent inbox; no new surface

**SUCCESS CRITERION**

- ≥ 45 % of "how do I" tickets resolved without an agent, at unchanged CSAT, on the 200-ticket eval-set, by 30 Oct — *unchanged: users do not set the threshold*

**What they could not decide:** the 45 % threshold (the memo's flip point) · the model family (the eval-set) · the legal basis for using tickets (the audit).

*Illustrative example. Every change carries its evidence ("3 of 3 users never opened the tab"). The criterion did not move: users do not set the threshold.*

# Before you leave — and before 30 October

### NOW, IN YOUR TEAM · 11 MIN

- **03_product_brief.md v1 —** from 01 and 02: to-be process, MoSCoW (≤ 4 MUST, ≥ 5 WON'T), criterion = your flip point
- **governance.md · Session 3 —** data: sources, legal basis, purpose, retention, isolation, gaps — and the trust level per step
- **03_ai_lean_canvas.md —** start it now; finish it at home

### BEFORE S4 · RUN THE LOOP ONCE

- [ ] **03_user_research.md —** 3 conversations, 20 min each, Mom Test rules
- [ ] **03_prototype_link.md —** one clickable prototype, under an hour; 2 users try one task
- [ ] **03_product_brief.md v2 —** “what the users changed” · “what they could not decide”
- [ ] **spec.md + evals/tickets_v0.csv —** the spec skeleton and 20 tickets

### NEXT · S4 · 30 OCTOBER

- Start: the reviews.csv data audit (20 min)
- Live: your spec.md → a Streamlit prototype on real tickets
- Decode an agent's architecture
- We start from your brief v2 — the one users touched



# References & going further

## METHODS


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- Gebru et al., Datasheets for Datasets (CACM, 2021) · Mitchell et al., Model Cards (FAT*, 2019)
- Fitzpatrick, The Mom Test (2013) · Krug, Rocket Surgery Made Easy (2009) · Torres, Continuous Discovery Habits (2021) · Nielsen & Landauer (1993)
- Zinkevich, Rules of Machine Learning (Google) — rule #1


## REPORTS AND CASES CITED TODAY


- Reuters, J. Dastin, Amazon scraps secret AI recruiting tool (10 Oct 2018)
- McKinsey, The State of AI (Aug 2026) · McKinsey Global Institute, The economic potential of generative AI (June 2023)
- BCG, the 10-20-70 rule · Deloitte, State of AI in the Enterprise (Jan 2026)
- Gartner press releases (25 June 2025; 26 Aug 2025)
- Klarna press release (27 Feb 2024); Bloomberg (8 May 2025) · Octopus Energy (2023) · Morgan Stanley / OpenAI customer story
- Anthropic, Claude Design (Anthropic Labs, April 2026) · GDPR art. 5–6 · EU AI Act art. 10

# Map the process. Cut until it can fail. Then ask the users.



**01**
**Ten framing questions; question 3 in numbers**

**02**
**Redesign the process first: the AI goes where the pain is**

**03**
**RICE ranks, you decide: the riskiest feature is a MUST**

**04**
**Audit the data, prototype in an afternoon, test with five**

Bring your brief v2 on 30 October